

ALCHEMY AOE ALLIANCE

TYPE:
STANDARD
(STND)



PROJECT:
N/A

STND--005

REVISION: R2

Competition, General Rules

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1 - Referenced Documents

This standard has no components.

2 - Background

This Standard was created as part of a modularization project, to “break-out” recurring text from handbooks to minimize reading for returning players.

3 - Overview

This Standard provides definition for general set of tournament rules, independent of specific settings, and could be used by any community for any type of event.

4 - Payment

4.A - Compatibility

Participants who receive payment shall –if directed by the handbook– maintain an account on the defined Platform. If no Payment Platform is defined by the handbook, then participants shall select a Payment Platform that can liquefy the form of currency/assets awarded by the tournament and provide an address to the host.

4.B - Disbursement

Players and Creators who fail to provide a destination address within 48 hours of results calculation shall forfeit earnings, with those funds:

- donated back to the community treasury if subsequent events are in development.
- distributed among other earners, if no other events are in development.



4.C - Transaction Fees

Transaction fees to the address provided for §4.B are paid by the participant.

4.D - Scheduling

If the prize for the tournament consists of electronic assets, such as cryptocurrency, then any prize-winning participant has the right to schedule payout with the Tournament Host. In this way, value remains approximately constant from the time of transfer to the time of liquidation. The Tournament Host shall wait at least 48 hrs after publicly declaring prizes for scheduling requests. If a recipient does not request within that duration, then the Tournament Host may assume scheduling is not needed and begin payouts.

4.E - Export Control

Participants certify that the account or address provided in §4.A is attached to a country eligible for currency/asset import from the Tournament Host's Country of Origin. In this way, International Trade Compliance shall be maintained.

4.F - Tax Obligations

Participants shall determine their own tax obligations, if any, that may result from accumulation of tournament winnings.

5 - Accessibility

It is important for all participants to be able to find and communicate with each other. Registration will only be processed for persons in the Tournament Server.



6 - Registration Exceptions

The tournament host reserves the right to grant varying levels of exception for registrants who do not meet eligibility requirements. Such exceptions may be granted for persons who are “close” to eligibility requirements, familiar to the community, have well-understood skill level, or any combination. Exception could include privilege to play eligible or ineligible for prize winnings.

7 - Scheduling Exceptions

No exceptions or extensions will be granted to playing required sets on time.

8 - Going First

For the purposes of hosting drafts and lobbies, applying bans, etc., when applicable – the HIGHER SEED “goes first” unless otherwise specified.

9 - Civilization Restrictions

The following civilizations are forbidden and not be eligible for drafting:

- Jurchens (Three Kingdoms DLC)
- Khitans (Three Kingdoms DLC)
- Shu (Three Kingdoms DLC)
- Wei (Three Kingdoms DLC)
- Wu (Three Kingdoms DLC)



10 - Lobby Settings

Table 10 summarizes the required lobby settings:

Setting	Requirement
Hidden Civilizations	Enabled
Spectator Delay	2 Minutes
Data Mod	Default
Game Mode	Random Map
Map Style	Custom
Location	[A Map From The Pool]
Map Size	Tiny (2 Player)
AI Difficulty	Standard
Resources	Standard
Population	200
Game Speed	Normal
Reveal Map	Normal
Starting Age	Standard
Ending Age	Standard
Treaty Length	<None>
Victory	Standard
Lock Teams?	Yes
Team Together?	Yes
Team Positions?	No
Shared Exploration?	No
Lock Speed?	Yes
Allow Cheats?	No
Turbo Mode?	No
Full Tech Tree?	No
Empire Wars Mode?	No
Sudden Death Mode?	No
Regicide Mode?	No
Record Game?	Yes
Antiquity Mode?	No

Table 10: Lobby Settings for All Tournament Games



11 - Creative Strategies

Laming/Tower Rushes/Town Center Drops are all 100% allowed. Creative strategies are important to the success of the competition.

12 - Nomad Unit Entrapment

On nomad maps, trapping an enemy unit against a forest or another resource using quick-walling before minute 5 is forbidden.

13 - Restarts

13.A - Map-Induced

Although rare, a map-induced restart is allowed if at least one of the following are true.

- Resources are missing, inaccessible, or at least 50% of their surface area is blocked by terrain or another resource.
- Starting player-controlled units are missing or trapped by terrain or resources.

13.B - Wrong Civ Picked

If a player accidentally selects a forbidden civilization after the game is launched (thus having seen the opponent's civilization), then the game is restarted with that opponent selecting a civilization for the mistaken player from their available draft.

14 - Cheating

Cheating is forbidden. The following are considered cheating:

- Bug exploits.

- Receipt of information from anyone who is not an opponent or tournament administrator during a league game.
- Failure to disclose all relevant alternate/“smurf” accounts during registration, thereby attempting to mislead the tournament elo calculation.

15 - Performance Tracking

Participants give consent for their performance to be publicly shared and viewable by anyone, including competitors.

16 - Recording Availability

After playing in each round, recordings proving the outcome shall be uploaded to the appropriate channel in the Tournament Server before the start of the next round. Such an upload is ultimately the responsibility of whoever won the set, but the community appreciates being unable to predict the winner based on who posted the results.

The following information shall also be included:

- Round Number
- @Player names
- Match Result (Use spoiler tag, sandwich between players)
- Map Draft Link, or if not applicable, names of maps played
- Civilization Draft Link, if applicable
- Game Recording Files

A spoiler tag may be attached through use of two vertical bars at the start and end of the message:

|| this is a spoiler message ||

For example, if TechChariot were wiped out by SmurfChariot in Round 4, then the results could be posted by either player as follows:

Round 4 @TechChariot || 0 - 2 || @SmurfChariot

Map Draft Link: www.aoe2mapdrafts.com

Civ Draft Link: www.aoe2civdrafts.com

TechChariot_vs_SmurfChariot_G1.aoe2record

TechChariot_vs_SmurfChariot_G2.aoe2record

17 - Behavioral Code of Conduct

Server rules apply to all tournament activities, including direct messaging and in-game chat.

18 - Cosmopolitan Community

The community does not exclude people on the basis of protected class or unpopular beliefs/associations. Its events are designed to unify Age of Empires II players, creators, and viewers around love of the game. Anyone is welcome to participate, as long as they:

- Make a credible pledge to meet the requirements of the handbook.
- Provide an honest estimation of their skill, such that selection of worthy opponents may be done with confidence.

Signatures:

TechChariot

2025-03-29

Prepared

*Date (YYYY-MM-DD)*CookiePirate

2025-07-12

Checked

*Date (YYYY-MM-DD)*Honeybadger

2025-07-12

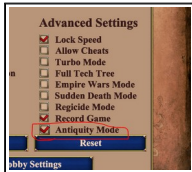
Approved

Date (YYYY-MM-DD)

Revision History:

Revision	Description	Change Document	Date (YYYY-MM-DD)
X1	-- Advanced Release for Community Review --	N/A	2025-04-28
OI	---- Original Issue ----	N/A	2025-07-12
R1	§ 4.A, revised FROM: “Participants are responsible for ensuring they can receive payment through the platform selected by the tournament, from the Country of Origin.” TO: “Participants who receive payment shall –if directed by the handbook– maintain an account on the defined Platform. If no Payment Platform is defined by the handbook, then participants shall select a Payment Platform that can liquefy the form of currency/assets awarded by the tournament and provide an address to the host.” § 4.C, revised FROM: “Transaction fees to the address provided for §4.B are paid by the tournament.” TO: “Transaction fees to the address provided for §4.B are paid by the participant.” Added § 4.D, “Scheduling” Added § 4.E, “Export Control” Added § 4.F, “Tax Obligations” Added § 9, “Civilization Restrictions” § 11, second sentence, revised FROM: “Creative strategies are important to the success of the League.” TO: “Creative strategies are important to the success of the competition.” § 16, fourth bullet point, revised FROM: Names of maps that were played” TO: “Map Draft Link, or if not applicable, names of maps played” § 16, added bullet between current 4th and 5th regarding civilizations § 16, revised FROM: “Round 4 @TechChariot 0 - 2 @SmurfChariot – Map1, Map2” TO: “Round 4 @TechChariot 0 - 2 @SmurfChariot”, then in the next line, prior to “TechChariot_vs_SmurfChariot_G1.aoe2record” , added lines for Map and Civilization drafts.	N/A	2025-08-29
R2	§ 4.B, revised FROM:	N/A	2025-11-29



STND--005		Competition, General Rules		REV: R2	
R2	“Players and Creators eligible for prize winnings shall provide an address within: • one week of the <i>end</i> of play period (for Players). • one week of the <i>start</i> of play period (for Creators). With a valid destination, winnings transferred within: • two weeks of the <i>end</i> of play period (for Players). • two weeks of the <i>start</i> of play period (for Creators).” TO: “Players and Creators who fail to provide a destination address within 48 hours of results calculation shall forfeit earnings, with those funds: • donated back to the community treasury if subsequent events are in development. • distributed among other earners, if no other events are in development.”	N/A	2025-11-29		
	§ 10, revised final table row (Antiquity Mode), column 2 FROM: “Yes” TO: “No”. § 10, removed Figure and caption: Note from Table 10 that the new “Antiquity Mode” is <i>enabled</i>, allowing additional options from a recent game patch. Figure 10 demonstrates:  <i>Figure 10: Enabling New Antiquity Mode</i>				
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